

Cover Story | Laptop Test



Scoreboard

Just Your Regular Laptop

BRAND	Acer	Acer	ACi	ACi	ACi
MODEL	Aspire 5551	TravelMate 2428	Emerald C2	Icon S	Ethos Duo 1530
Features					
Processor Type / GHz	Core Duo T2250/1.73	Pentium M 745/1.8	Celeron M 360J/1.4	Pentium M 725/1.6	Core Duo T2300/1.66
Chipset	Intel 945GM	Intel 915GM	Intel 910GML	Intel 915GM	Intel 945GM
Memory Type / Speed / Amount	DDR2/533MHz/256MB	DDR2/533MHz/256MB	DDR2/533MHz/256MB	DDR2/533MHz/512MB	DDR2/533MHz/512MB
Graphics					
Integrated / Dedicated	Integrated	Integrated	Integrated	Integrated	Integrated
Graphics system / Max. memory allocated	Intel 82915GM/128MB	Intel 82915GM/128MB	Intel 82910GML/128MB	Intel 82915GM/128MB	Intel 82945GM/128MB
TFT Display					
Screen Size / Native resolution	14.1 Wide/1280x800	14.1 Wide/1280x800	14.1 / 1024x768	14.1/1024x768	15.4 Wide/1280x800
Storage					
Hard disk (capacity, speed)	60 GB, 5400 rpm	60 GB, 5400 rpm	40 GB, 5400 rpm	80 GB, 5400 rpm	80 GB, 5400 rpm
Optical drive type	DVD-Writer	Combo drive	Combo drive	Combo drive	Combo drive
Ports					
USB (nos.) / FireWire (nos.)	2/0	3/0	3/0	3/1	4/1
Expansion slot type PCMCIA (Type I/II)	Type II	Type II	Type II	Type II	Type II
Connectivity					
IrDA/Wi-Fi/Bluetooth/Ethernet	✗/a,b,g/✓/10/100	✗/b,g/✗/10/100	✗/b/✗/10/100	✓/b,g/✗/10/100	✓/a,b,g/✓/Gigabit
Audio-Video OUT options					
S-video out / Monitor D-sub	✗/✓	✗/✓	✗/✗	✗/✓	✓/✓
Memory Card Reader					
Type of cards that can be read	SD, XD, MS Pro, MMC	✗	✗	SD, MMC	SD, MMC, MS/Pro, XD
Miscellaneous Features	Wi-Fi and Bluetooth switch	Browser / e-mail buttons	Browser / e-mail buttons and media player button	✗	Volume control buttons
Usability					
Dimensions (L x B x H) (cm)	33 x 25.5 x 3.5	33.3 x 24.3 x 3.8	31 x 25.5 x 3.5	31.5 x 26 x 3	36 x 27 x 4.25
Weight (kg)	2.38	2.3	2.2	2.4	2.8
Overall ergonomics (So5)	3.50	3.50	3.75	3.17	3.50
Built-in speaker quality test (So5)	3	3	3	2.5	3
Package Contents					
Preloaded OS	Linux	Windows XP Pro SP2	Linux	Linux	Linux
Driver/Recovery CDs	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Miscellaneous	✗	✗	Nero Burning ROM	Nero Burning ROM	NTI CD DVD maker
Carry case	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Performance					
Overall system benchmarks					
ZD-Bench Business Winstone 2004	18	18.7	16.4	Failed	22.3
Video encoding test	155	158	198	Failed	147
SiSoft Sandra 2007 Engineer's edition					
CPU - Dhrystone / Whetstone	11786/8724	5529/4365	4576/3415	5002/3738	11337/8354
Multimedia - CPU Integer / FPU SSE	26996/36798	16028/18830	13018/14715	14295/16146	25954/35256
Int bandwidth / Float bandwidth (MB/s)	2950/2957	1828/1821	2303/2307	1896/1902	3118/3119
Drive Index MB/s / Random access (ms)	31/10	32/10	29/9	30/9	27/12
Call of Duty (800 x 600 / 1024 x 768) fps	33.8/33.4	35.4/29.8	31/27	43/35.5	48.8/43
PCMark 2004 (Build 1.3.0)					
CPU / Memory	4619/2993	3489/2727	2681/2268	Failed/Failed	4901/3312
Graphics / HDD	936/3189	770/3257	634/2588	Failed/Failed	930/2949
Overall	4250	3078	2382	Failed	4367
DisplayMate					
Viewing angle	155	155	155	155	150
Average DisplayMate score	3.8	4	3.6	3.7	3.9
Battery life (Hours:Minutes)	2:16	2:19	2:33	2:59	2
Final Score					
Features (Out of 30)	19.26	17.59	16.32	18.09	21.52
Performance (Out of 50)	32.34	30.06	27.70	27.76	33.62
Price Index (Out of 20)	9.55	12.31	17.00	12.14	8.85
Grand Total	61.15	59.96	61.02	57.99	64.00
Price (Rs)	44,499	34,499	24,990	34,990	47,990

* Same result even after repeated attempts



+ Good finish
- Low on RAM



+ Value for money
- Low on RAM



+ Value for money
- Looks drab



+ Value for money
- Poor build quality



+ Good bundle
- Mushy keyboard